

Adapting Incremental MaxSAT from RTSS to CVRP

A Detailed Technical Guide

Technical Documentation

December 19, 2025

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1 Introduction

1.1 Motivation

The Real-Time Taxi-Sharing Service (RTSS) problem and the Capacitated Vehicle Routing Problem (CVRP) share fundamental similarities:

- Both involve routing multiple vehicles
- Both have capacity constraints
- Both require optimization of total distance/cost
- Both are NP-hard combinatorial optimization problems

The RTSS paper by Zha et al. introduces an **Incremental MaxSAT** approach that efficiently solves the problem by:

1. Encoding the problem using **connection variables** $l(i, j)$ and **reachability variables** $r(i, j)$
2. Using **lazy constraint checking** for capacity/deadline constraints
3. Applying **incremental SAT solving** with the RC2 solver

This document details how to adapt this methodology to CVRP.

1.2 Key Differences

Aspect	RTSS	CVRP
Depot	Multiple (current taxi positions)	Single central depot
Route Structure	Open path (no return to start)	Closed circuit (return to depot)
Constraints	Capacity + Deadline	Capacity only
Customer Type	Pick-up and Drop-off pairs	Single service points
Ordering	Pick-up must precede drop-off	No pairing constraints
Time Dimension	Real-time, dynamic	Static, offline

Table 1: Comparison of RTSS and CVRP

2 RTSS Methodology Overview

2.1 Boolean Variable Encoding

The RTSS approach uses two types of Boolean variables:

Definition 2.1 (Connection Variable $l(i, j)$). $l(i, j) = \text{True}$ if and only if the vehicle travels **directly** from location i to location j (i.e., (i, j) is an edge in the route).

Definition 2.2 (Reachability Variable $r(i, j)$). $r(i, j) = \text{True}$ if and only if location i is visited **before** location j in the route.

Key Insight: The relationship between l and r is:

$$l(i, j) \Rightarrow r(i, j) \quad (1)$$

If we use edge (i, j) , then i must be visited before j .

2.2 Hamiltonian Path Constraints

The RTSS paper encodes Hamiltonian path constraints using reachability variables with the following logical laws:

2.2.1 Implication Rule

$$l(i, j) \Rightarrow r(i, j) \quad (2)$$

2.2.2 Transitivity Law

$$r(a, b) \wedge r(b, c) \Rightarrow r(a, c) \quad (3)$$

2.2.3 Chain Law

$$r(a, b) \wedge r(b, c) \Rightarrow \neg l(c, a) \quad (4)$$

(Prevents “jumping back” over an intermediate node)

2.2.4 Acyclic Law

$$\neg(r(a, b) \wedge r(b, a)) \quad (5)$$

(Ordering is asymmetric)

2.3 Incremental Solving Strategy

Algorithm 1 RTSS Incremental Solving (solveRTSS)

Require: WCNF formula with soft/hard clauses, RC2 solver

Ensure: Feasible solution or UNSAT

```

1:  $model \leftarrow rc2.compute()$ 
2: while  $model \neq \text{None}$  do
3:    $route \leftarrow \text{decodeModel}(model)$ 
4:    $violation, nogood \leftarrow \text{checkExCondition}(route)$ 
5:   if NOT  $violation$  then
6:     return  $model$  ▷ Found feasible solution
7:   else
8:      $rc2.add\_clause(nogood)$  ▷ Add nogood and continue
9:      $model \leftarrow rc2.compute()$ 
10:  end if
11: end while
12: return UNSAT

```

The key function `checkExCondition` checks:

1. **Capacity violations:** Total demand exceeds vehicle capacity
2. **Deadline violations:** Arrival time exceeds deadline

When a violation is found, a **nogood clause** is generated that says “don’t use this exact route configuration again”.

3 Adapting to CVRP

3.1 Variable Mapping

For CVRP with n customers and m vehicles:

RTSS	CVRP	Description
$l_k(i, j)$	$\text{conNet}[v][i][j]$	Edge from i to j on vehicle v
$r_k(i, j)$	$\text{rchNet}[v][i][j]$	i before j on vehicle v
taxi k	vehicle v	Vehicle index $v \in \{0, \dots, m-1\}$
via points	customers	Customer index $i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$
pick/drop	single node	Each customer is a single service point

Table 2: Variable Mapping from RTSS to CVRP

3.2 Modified Constraints

3.2.1 Depot Constraints (Different from RTSS)

In CVRP, vehicles start and end at the **same depot** (node 0):

$$\sum_{j=1}^n \text{conNet}[v][0][j] = 1, \quad \forall v \in \{0, \dots, m-1\} \quad (\text{C1: Leave depot once})$$

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \text{conNet}[v][i][0] = 1, \quad \forall v \in \{0, \dots, m-1\} \quad (\text{C2: Return to depot once})$$

3.2.2 Flow Conservation

Each customer is visited exactly once by exactly one vehicle:

$$\sum_{v=0}^{m-1} \sum_{i=0, i \neq j}^n \text{conNet}[v][i][j] = 1, \quad \forall j \in \{1, \dots, n\} \quad (\text{C3: One entry per customer})$$

$$\sum_{v=0}^{m-1} \sum_{k=0, k \neq j}^n \text{conNet}[v][j][k] = 1, \quad \forall j \in \{1, \dots, n\} \quad (\text{C4: One exit per customer})$$

3.2.3 Vehicle Consistency Constraint (NEW)

If a customer is visited by vehicle v , both incoming and outgoing edges must belong to the SAME vehicle:

$$\text{conNet}[v][i][j] \wedge \text{conNet}[v'][j][k] \Rightarrow \text{False}, \quad \forall v \neq v' \quad (\text{C5: Vehicle consistency})$$

In CNF: $\neg \text{conNet}[v][i][j] \vee \neg \text{conNet}[v'][j][k]$

This ensures that a customer's incoming and outgoing edges are on the same vehicle.

3.2.4 Reachability Constraints (Same as RTSS)

Implication:

$$\text{conNet}[v][i][j] \Rightarrow \text{rchNet}[v][i][j] \quad (6)$$

In CNF: $\neg \text{conNet}[v][i][j] \vee \text{rchNet}[v][i][j]$

Transitivity:

$$\text{rchNet}[v][a][b] \wedge \text{rchNet}[v][b][c] \Rightarrow \text{rchNet}[v][a][c] \quad (7)$$

In CNF: $\neg \text{rchNet}[v][a][b] \vee \neg \text{rchNet}[v][b][c] \vee \text{rchNet}[v][a][c]$

Chain Law:

$$\text{rchNet}[v][a][b] \wedge \text{rchNet}[v][b][c] \Rightarrow \neg \text{conNet}[v][c][a] \quad (8)$$

In CNF: $\neg \text{rchNet}[v][a][b] \vee \neg \text{rchNet}[v][b][c] \vee \neg \text{conNet}[v][c][a]$

No Back-and-Forth:

$$\neg(\text{conNet}[v][i][j] \wedge \text{conNet}[v][j][i]) \quad (9)$$

In CNF: $\neg \text{conNet}[v][i][j] \vee \neg \text{conNet}[v][j][i]$

3.3 Variable Reduction Trick

Key optimization from RTSS:

For customers $i < j$ on the same vehicle, if $r(i, j) = \text{True}$, then $r(j, i) = \text{False}$.

Therefore, we only need ONE variable for each unordered pair:

$$\text{rchNet}[v][i][j] = \text{var_id} \quad (\text{new variable}) \quad (10)$$

$$\text{rchNet}[v][j][i] = \neg \text{var_id} \quad (\text{negation}) \quad (11)$$

This reduces the number of reachability variables by half!

3.4 Lazy Capacity Checking

Instead of encoding capacity constraints upfront (which requires complex cardinality constraints), we check capacity **after** finding a solution:

Algorithm 2 Check Capacity Violation for CVRP

```
1: function CHECKCAPACITY(route, demands, Q)
2:   total_demand  $\leftarrow \sum_{c \in \text{route}} \text{demands}[c]$ 
3:   if total_demand > Q then
4:     return (True, GenerateNogood(route))
5:   else
6:     return (False, None)
7:   end if
8: end function
```

3.5 Nogood Clause Generation

When a route $R = [0, c_1, c_2, \dots, c_k, 0]$ violates capacity:

$$\text{nogood} = \neg \text{conNet}[v][0][c_1] \vee \neg \text{conNet}[v][c_1][c_2] \vee \dots \vee \neg \text{conNet}[v][c_k][0] \quad (12)$$

This clause says: “At least one of these edges must NOT be used.”

Adding this clause eliminates the current infeasible solution and allows the solver to find alternatives.

4 Implementation Details

4.1 Data Structures

Listing 1: Core Data Structures

```
1 class IncrementalCVRPSolver:
2   def __init__(self, n_customers, n_vehicles, distances, demands,
3               capacity):
4     self.n = n_customers + 1 # Including depot
5     self.m = n_vehicles
6     self.distances = distances
7     self.demands = demands
8     self.capacity = capacity
9
10    # Connection network: conNet[v][i][j] = variable ID
11    self.conNet = [[[0] * self.n for _ in range(self.n)]
12                  for _ in range(self.m)]
13
14    # Reachability network: rchNet[v][i][j] = variable ID (or
15    # negation)
16    self.rchNet = [[[0] * self.n for _ in range(self.n)]
17                  for _ in range(self.m)]
18
19    # WCNF formula
20    self.wcnf = WCNF()
```

4.2 Variable Generation

Listing 2: Variable Generation with Optimization

```
1 def gen_var_for_rch_net(self):
2     """Generate reachability variables with negation trick."""
3     for v in range(self.m):
4         for i in range(1, self.n):
5             for j in range(i + 1, self.n): # Only i < j
6                 if self.is_valid_edge(v, i, j):
7                     var = self.new_var_id()
8                     self.rchNet[v][i][j] = var
9                     self.rchNet[v][j][i] = -var # Negation!
```

4.3 Incremental Solving Loop

Listing 3: Main Incremental Solving Loop

```
1 def solve_incremental(self, timeout=300):
2     with RC2(self.wcnf, incr=True) as solver:
3         while True:
4             model = solver.compute()
5
6             if model is None:
7                 return None # UNSAT
8
9             routes = self.decode_all_routes(model)
10
11             # Check capacity for each vehicle
12             is_feasible, violation = self.check_solution(routes)
13
14             if is_feasible:
15                 return routes, solver.cost
16             else:
17                 # Generate and add nogood clause
18                 v, violating_route = violation
19                 nogood = self.generate_nogood_clause(v,
20                                                         violating_route)
21                 solver.add_clause(nogood)
```

4.4 K-Nearest Neighbors Integration

To combine with the CVRP post-improvement approach, we use K-nearest neighbors to restrict the search space:

Listing 4: K-Nearest Neighbors for Search Space Reduction

```
1 def compute_k_neighbors(self, initial_routes=None):
2     """Compute valid edges based on K-nearest neighbors."""
3     for i in range(self.n):
4         # Sort neighbors by distance
```



```

5      dists = [(j, self.distances[i, j])
6                for j in range(self.n) if i != j]
7      dists.sort(key=lambda x: x[1])
8
9      # Take K nearest
10     k_nearest = [j for j, _ in dists[:self.k_neighbors]]
11
12     # Mark as valid for all vehicles
13     for v in range(self.m):
14         for j in k_nearest:
15             self.valid_edges[v][i][j] = True
16
17     # Ensure initial route edges are valid
18     if initial_routes:
19         for v, route in initial_routes.items():
20             full_route = [0] + route + [0]
21             for idx in range(len(full_route) - 1):
22                 i, j = full_route[idx], full_route[idx + 1]
23                 self.valid_edges[v][i][j] = True

```

5 Complete Algorithm

Algorithm 3 Incremental MaxSAT for CVRP

Require: Instance (n, m, D, q, Q) , K-neighbors parameter

Ensure: Optimal routes or UNSAT

```
1: Phase 1: Initialization
2: Compute K-nearest neighbor matrix
3: Generate connection variables  $\text{conNet}[v][i][j]$ 
4: Generate reachability variables  $\text{rchNet}[v][i][j]$ 
5: Phase 2: Generate Base Clauses
6: Generate soft clauses (objective function)
7: Generate hard clauses (Hamiltonian path constraints)
8: Generate hard clauses (depot in/out constraints)
9: Generate hard clauses (flow conservation)
10: Phase 3: Incremental Solving
11: Initialize RC2 solver with WCNF
12: repeat
13:    $\text{model} \leftarrow \text{solver.compute}()$ 
14:   if  $\text{model} = \text{None}$  then
15:     return UNSAT
16:   end if
17:    $\text{routes} \leftarrow \text{DecodeRoutes}(\text{model})$ 
18:    $\text{feasible}, \text{violation} \leftarrow \text{CheckCapacity}(\text{routes})$ 
19:   if NOT  $\text{feasible}$  then
20:      $\text{nogood} \leftarrow \text{GenerateNogood}(\text{violation})$ 
21:      $\text{solver.add\_clause}(\text{nogood})$ 
22:   end if
23: until  $\text{feasible}$ 
24: return  $\text{routes}, \text{solver.cost}$ 
```

6 Theoretical Analysis

6.1 Correctness

Theorem 6.1 (Soundness). If the algorithm returns a solution, it is a feasible CVRP solution.

Proof. The hard clauses enforce:

1. Each vehicle leaves and returns to depot exactly once
2. Each customer is visited exactly once
3. No subtours (enforced by reachability constraints)

The lazy checking ensures capacity constraints are satisfied before returning. $\square$

Theorem 6.2 (Completeness). If a feasible solution exists, the algorithm will find one.

Proof. The nogood clauses only eliminate infeasible solutions. Since there are finitely many route configurations, the algorithm terminates. $\square$

6.2 Complexity Analysis

- **Variables:** $O(m \cdot n^2)$ for connection and reachability
- **Hard clauses:** $O(m \cdot n^3)$ for transitivity
- **Soft clauses:** $O(m \cdot K \cdot n)$ with K-neighbors
- **Iterations:** Worst case exponential, but typically few in practice

6.3 Advantages over MTZ Formulation

1. **No auxiliary integer variables:** MTZ requires u_i position variables
2. **Tighter relaxation:** Reachability constraints provide stronger propagation
3. **Incremental solving:** Can add clauses without rebuilding the model
4. **Variable reduction:** Negation trick halves reachability variables

7 Comparison with Original CVRP Approach

Feature	Original CVRP (clasp)	Incremental (RTSS-style)
Solver	clasp (external)	PySAT RC2 (Python)
Subtour Elimination	MTZ with binary encoding	Reachability variables
Capacity Handling	Cardinality constraints	Lazy checking + nogoods
Incremental	No (rebuild for each change)	Yes (add clauses on-the-fly)
Initial Solution	Required (CW + 2-opt)	Optional (warm start)
Variable Count	$O(n^2 \log n)$ for MTZ	$O(n^2)$ for reachability

Table 3: Comparison of CVRP Solving Approaches

8 Usage Example

Listing 5: Complete Usage Example

```

1 from incremental_cvrp_solver import IncrementalCVRPSolver
2 import numpy as np
3
4 # Create instance
5 n_customers = 5
6 n_vehicles = 2
7 capacity = 10
8 demands = np.array([0, 3, 4, 3, 4, 3]) # depot + customers
9 distances = np.array([...]) # Distance matrix
10
11 # Create solver
12 solver = IncrementalCVRPSolver(
13     n_customers=n_customers,

```

```

14     n_vehicles=n_vehicles,
15     distances=distances,
16     demands=demands,
17     capacity=capacity,
18     k_neighbors=4
19 )
20
21 # Solve
22 routes, cost, time = solver.build_and_solve(timeout=60)
23
24 # Output
25 print(f"Cost: {cost}")
26 for v, route in routes.items():
27     print(f"Vehicle {v}: 0 -> {' -> '.join(map(str, route))} -> 0")

```

9 Experimental Results

9.1 Small Instance Test

Testing on a 5-customer, 2-vehicle instance:

- Customers: 5
- Vehicles: 2
- Capacity: 10
- Demands: [3, 4, 3, 4, 3]

Results:

Cost: 105

Time: 1.33s

Iterations: 21

Capacity violations found: 20

Routes:

Vehicle 0: 0 -> 5 -> 4 -> 3 -> 0 (Demand: 10/10)

Vehicle 1: 0 -> 2 -> 1 -> 0 (Demand: 7/10)

The solver correctly found a feasible solution after eliminating 20 capacity-violating solutions through nogood clauses.

10 Conclusion

This document presented a detailed adaptation of the RTSS Incremental MaxSAT approach to CVRP:

1. **Variable Encoding:** Connection variables $l(i, j)$ and reachability variables $r(i, j)$ from RTSS are directly applicable to CVRP.

2. **Constraint Adaptation:** The main changes are:
 - Modified depot constraints (single depot, return required)
 - Simplified customer model (no pick-up/drop-off pairs)
 - Removed deadline constraints (capacity only)
3. **Lazy Checking:** Capacity constraints are checked post-hoc and violations are eliminated via nogood clauses.
4. **Incremental Solving:** The RC2 solver supports adding clauses incrementally, enabling efficient exploration of the solution space.
5. **K-Neighbors Integration:** The search space can be restricted using K-nearest neighbors, combining the benefits of both approaches.

The implementation is provided in `incremental_cvrp_solver.py`.